



SAFE SPACE SETUP CHECKLIST



A calm, comfortable space can help my child feel safe, regulated, and ready to handle big feelings.



Safe Space Location: _____

Date Set Up / Reviewed: _____



COMFORT

Cozy and calming things that help my child feel safe.

- ☐ Comfortable seating (bean bag, cushion, floor pillow, chair)
- ☐ Soft blanket or throw
- ☐ Calming colors / low lighting
- ☐ Quiet and away from high-traffic areas
- ☐ Good temperature



TOOLS & RESOURCES

Helpful tools to support regulation and coping.

- ☐ Fidget tools (fidgets, stress ball, pop it)
- ☐ Calming tools (sensory items, squishy, texture items)
- ☐ Breathing or grounding tools (pinwheel, breathing cards, timers)
- ☐ Visuals or feeling charts
- ☐ Books or social stories
- ☐ Noise-canceling headphones (if helpful)



SENSORY CONSIDERATIONS

Reduce overwhelm and support sensory needs.

- ☐ Minimize loud noises and distractions
- ☐ Adjust lighting (soft, natural, or dim)
- ☐ Consider smells (neutral or calming)
- ☐ Include items that support sensory needs
- ☐ Allow movement if helpful (wobble cushion, resistance band, etc.)



PERSONALIZATION

Make it a space that feels welcoming and meaningful.

- ☐ Include my child's favorite items
- ☐ Decorate with things that bring comfort or joy
- ☐ Involve my child in creating the space
- ☐ Add positive reminders or affirmations ("I am safe", "I can handle hard things")



ROUTINE & USE

Help my child know when and how to use their safe space.

- ☐ Explain the purpose of the safe space
- ☐ Create a plan for when to use it
- ☐ Practice using the space when calm
- ☐ Respect my child's need for space
- ☐ Check in and adjust as needed

My Plan

1. I feel my body getting upset.
2. I take a break in my safe space.
3. I use tools that help me.
4. I feel calm and ready.



NOTES / WHAT WORKS WELL:



MAINTENANCE CHECK:

- ☐ Check items regularly
- ☐ Replace or refresh as needed
- ☐ Ask my child what else would help them feel safe



A safe space is not a punishment. It is a tool for regulation, connection, and building skills that last a lifetime.

